

Nearly all the outsiders have a greater or lesser interest in the course of the market. Some of them stand by the railing that surrounds the pit, others watch the battle afar off, standing between the entrance rail and the door. These outside operators have faces strongly marked by the exciting life they lead. Their features often become set into a fixed expression of anxiety. They gaze at the scale of prices with an apparent apathy, disturbed by the pain of loss or lighted up by the pleasure of gain only for an instant. Some of them seem to wear the waxen mask which grows on the faces of gamblers covering every emotion and rarely dropped except when some keener pang or more intense thrill startles them off their guard.

*The Long Room is like Bedlam broke loose.
The pit is jammed with buyers and sellers,
brandishing their arms, shrieking with every
variety of tone . . .*

The combat between the bulls and bears commences with light skirmishing. As the day wears away, the solid columns move against each other, under a fire of heavy artillery. The bears begin to give ground and their banners wander in disarray. Suddenly a deafening hubbub breaks out from the pit. New York Central has risen ten per cent. in as many minutes. Some great bear is buying stock to cover his contracts, his followers rush after him and the whole army of bears are soon at work buying in or settling up. The bulls have won the day, and after counting the dead, wounded and missing, and reckoning the spoils and losses, respectively, the armies retreat to their camps, and prepare for new campaigns.

The association known as the New York Stock Exchange, was formed early in the present century. It germinated sixty years ago, in a little clique of stock dealers numbering scarcely a round dozen, who were wont to meet under a sycamore tree,